

REVIEW OF CHALLENGED INSTRUCTIONAL AND LIBRARY MATERIALS

This regulation supplements [Policy 5047](#) by providing procedures for the committees reviewing challenged instructional and library materials. The Superintendent or designee shall appoint a Division-level review committee with at least: two Division instructional administrators; two LCPS school-based licensed instructional employees within the school level of the request; and three LCPS parents within the school level of the request. At least one of the school-based employees should be a teacher certified in the content area where the challenge arose. The Division-level committee shall review the material and make a recommendation to the Superintendent.

A. Selection of Review Committee. Members of the Division-level committee discussed in Policy 5047 will be selected as follows.

1. Division-Level Instructional Administrative Staff Participants. A current list of all Division-level instructional administrative staff in the Department of School Leadership and Department of Academics is maintained by the Library Media Services Supervisor. Participants for each review will be randomly selected.

2. School-Level Licensed Instructional Staff Participants. School-level licensed instructional staff interested in serving on review committees are invited to express interest through the Participation Form located on the Library Media Services website at the beginning of August each year. Participants are placed in a pool by school level (elementary, middle, high) and content area and randomly selected for each review. Participants from the school that initiated the challenge will not be selected.

3. Parent/Guardian Participants. Parents/guardians that have a child currently enrolled in LCPS who are interested in serving on review committees are invited to express interest by completing the Instructional Material Challenge Parent Participation Form located on the Library Media Services webpage beginning in August of each school year. Qualified participants are placed in a pool by school level (elementary, middle, high) and randomly selected for each review. Participants from the school that initiated the challenge will not be selected.

B. Division-Level Committee's Process for Reviewing Challenged Instructional and Library Materials.

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1. When a challenge to instructional or library materials is received and the Division-level committee is formed, the Library Media Services Supervisor will share a copy of the appropriate policies and accompanying regulations, a copy of the challenge (with names of those who submitted the challenge redacted), a copy of the material being challenged/reviewed, any reviews of the material that can be found in professional book review journals, websites, reviews online, and information about the creators of the resource (e.g., authors, illustrators). Prior to the committee meeting, committee members must review the accompanying information and the material being challenged in its entirety.

2. The Division-level committee will meet in person to discuss the resource and make a recommendation to the Superintendent on the disposition of the challenge. The recommendation shall be one of the following:

- a. Materials are to remain in their current use,
- b. Materials are to be moved to a higher grade level and/or only made available at a particular level(s),
- c. Materials are to be removed from the schools,
- d. Access to the materials is to be expanded, or
- e. Materials are to be recategorized as sexually explicit or not.

3. The Library and Media Services Supervisor will facilitate the Division-level committee's work and summarize the findings for the Superintendent. The Superintendent will make the final decision which will be posted on the LCPS website and applied division wide.

Issued: 5/14/2025

Cross Ref: [Policy 5047](#), Review of Challenged Instructional and Library Materials